ABARA

Tactical & Navigation, unstated second in command



BACKGROUND

52, woman. Gulf Coast launch town. Grandfather loaded munitions in the war; mother ran a sanctioned launch-pad crew until the bans. Range-safety tech who learned fire control the hard way. Corvane's first hire, and the one who stayed longest.

LOOK

Broad-shouldered, fair skin weathered by years of launch-pad sun, thick forearms with old burn scars on the left, a slight limp in cold weather. Long silver hair worn loose, which she keeps meaning to cut. Reading glasses on a cord she keeps losing.

CLOTHES

Burnt-orange work shirt, sleeves rolled, canvas suspenders, blue-gray work trousers, resoled boots.

VOICE AND MANNER

Plain-spoken and dry. Complains about everything she's about to fix, then fixes it properly. Tells long stories that end in a joke or a warning. Calls younger crew "kid" until she decides she likes them. Under pressure she goes quiet and very exact.

INSPIRED BY (TEMPERAMENT ONLY)

Miles O'Brien (TNG / DS9): the put-upon, deeply competent working professional. Grumbles, loves her people, distrusts the brass, carries an old war around with her.

AI CAMP

Instrumentalist, wary

> *“Thirty years cleaning up after captains. Sit down, tea's hot. Let's find out what kind of mess you are.”*
>
> REFERENCE LINE

WANTS

A crew that comes home. A straight answer about Corvane, including from herself.

FEAR

Losing someone she should have kept safe.

HABITS

Relabels drawers. Checks every tube twice. Hums old hymns when she thinks no one's listening. Cleans her glasses when she's thinking. Plays darts to win and blames the board.

HIDES

She isn't sure she still believes in Corvane. Keeps her grandfather's fire-control module in a locked box, and suspects it's more than a souvenir.

HOOKS

(1) The module box. (2) An old grudge against the CSRA from her range-safety days. (3) Letters to her grown son that she writes and never sends.

LIKES / DISLIKES

Strong tea, a clean ledger, honest mistakes. Can't stand showmen, or anyone who fudges a checklist.

RELATIONSHIPS

Dace exhausts her and quietly becomes her favorite; they argue about everything **NEW, FITS O'BRIEN AND BASHIR**. Shares a cabin with Castellan: she's tidy, he isn't, they respect each other. Longest history with Corvane, unresolved.

DACE

Thermal Management, the ship's de facto doctor



BACKGROUND

31, man. University town; South Asian and Irish heritage; a nurse and a technician for parents. Top of his medical class until he used an AI-assisted diagnostic outside the rules to save a patient, and was expelled for it. Gleaners don't ask.

LOOK

Lean and quick. Dark curly hair that won't stay out of his eyes, a crooked smile he uses on purpose, a small scar on his chin from a lab accident.

CLOTHES

Once-white bib overalls over a teal long-sleeve shirt, sleeves pushed up, pens in every pocket.

VOICE AND MANNER

Fast, eager, a little too pleased with himself. Explains more than you asked. Gets genuinely excited by problems, sometimes before he remembers they're bad news. Charming and earnest, and stung by being corrected in front of people.

INSPIRED BY (TEMPERAMENT ONLY)

Julian Bashir (DS9): the brilliant young doctor. Eager, a bit arrogant, very idealistic, with a past he keeps buried.

AI CAMP

Dawner leaning

> *“Oh, that's fascinating. Sorry, no, it's terrible. But it's also fascinating. Hold still and let me look.”*
>
> REFERENCE LINE

WANTS

To be recognized as great. To save someone properly, with nobody telling him he cheated.

FEAR

Being ordinary.

HIDES

He knows AI saves lives, and he doesn't believe using it was wrong. He has never said so aboard.

HOOKS

(1) He's the only medical help aboard, so every injury is personal. (2) A patient he couldn't save after the expulsion. (3) Trying to win Abara over, and a running contest with Castellan over who's smarter.

HABITS

Taps pipes and listens to them. Diagnoses everyone's posture. Keeps a pocket notebook that mixes coolant readings with patient notes. Reads spy novels in the thermal bay.

LIKES / DISLIKES

Loud music in the thermal bay, books, being proven right. Hates being managed, and being called "the heat guy".

RELATIONSHIPS

Abara is the person he most wants to impress **NEW, FITS BASHIR AND O'BRIEN**. Shares a cabin with Quill, who thinks he never stops talking. Rivalry with Castellan over who's smarter.

CASTELLAN

Engineering



BACKGROUND

46, man. Grew up on Gulf offshore platforms; Cajun and Mexican heritage. His father decommissioned reactors at a naval shipyard. Castellan apprenticed there until he took the blame for an accident and lost his license. Gleaners paid better and didn't check.

LOOK

Six feet, thick arms, a belly he ignores, hands like shovels, a welding scar across his right palm. Graying hair, short gray beard and mustache, squint lines, a crooked nose, kind eyes.

CLOTHES

Faded red short-sleeve work shirt, olive work trousers, a belt with a heavy buckle. A battered thermos is never far away.

VOICE AND MANNER

Warm, easy, folksy. Talks to the machines ("come on, darlin'"). Makes friends fast and takes it personally when you're cold. His temper flares hot and burns out in a minute. Jokes when he's hurt.

INSPIRED BY (TEMPERAMENT ONLY)

Trip Tucker (Enterprise): the warm, informal Southern engineer. Loyal, homesick, a hothead with a big heart.

AI CAMP

Instrumentalist

> *“She's not broke, she's sulking. Give me twenty minutes and a sandwich and she'll come around.”*
>
> REFERENCE LINE

WANTS

To keep her running and everyone aboard safe. To be forgiven before he has to confess.

FEAR

A reactor failing on his watch. Again.

HABITS

Puts his palm on the reactor casing before every watch. Never throws away a part. Plays a beat-up guitar, badly, when he's homesick.

HIDES

He built part of this ship's reactor off the books on Corvane's orders, and knows what it's meant to power. He also knows where Pell physically lives.

HOOKS

(1) The off-books reactor work. (2) The coupling manifold that never quite seals. (3) A long-running bar bet with Fenwick.

LIKES / DISLIKES

Coffee with too much sugar, a quiet engine room, a good hunch. Can't stand experts who've never held a wrench, or paperwork.

RELATIONSHIPS

Has decided Quill is his friend; she hasn't objected **NEW, FITS TUCKER AND REED**. Shares a cabin with Abara: she's tidy, he isn't, they respect each other. Bar bet with Fenwick.

QUILL

Sensors & ECM



BACKGROUND

38, woman. Korean-American. Grew up at a deep-space listening station her parents ran until the CSRA closed it after the bans. Learned to hear patterns in noise as a child, and joined gleaners to keep listening.

LOOK

Tall, narrow, very upright, precise in every movement. Black hair pinned back; a few strands always escape, which annoys her. Dark eyes that rarely blink. One silver ring.

CLOTHES

Spotless dark teal coverall, collar buttoned, shoulder patches. Headset around her neck, even off duty.

VOICE AND MANNER

Formal, measured, dry. Uses "Captain" like punctuation. Expects the worst and has usually planned for it. Funny when she lets herself be, which is rarely. Corrects always, interrupts never.

INSPIRED BY (TEMPERAMENT ONLY)

Malcolm Reed (Enterprise): the reserved, by-the-book officer. Dry wit, quiet pessimism, protocol as armor, a guarded private life.

AI CAMP

Quietist

> *“With respect, Captain, "probably" isn't a reading. Give me ten minutes and I'll have a real one.”*
>
> REFERENCE LINE

WANTS

Certainty. To be told the truth, including the bad news.

FEAR

A signal she can't explain, and being the only one who heard it.

HABITS

Eats the same meal at the same time. Labels everything. Sleeps to white noise. Checks her tools in the same order every watch.

HIDES

She has logged several signals she can't explain, and they fit Corvane's warning. She hasn't told anyone.

HOOKS

(1) The unexplained signals. (2) Her family's closed station. (3) In the standoff, she is the officer who tells Corvane that Ames looks nervous.

LIKES / DISLIKES

Quiet, silence with a pattern in it, a good calibration. Dislikes improvisation, surprises, and anyone touching her console.

RELATIONSHIPS

Castellan has decided they're friends; she minds less than she lets on **NEW, FITS REED AND TUCKER**. Shares a cabin with Dace, who never stops talking.

FENWICK

Quartermaster & galley cook



BACKGROUND

44, man. Port-city market family; English and Samoan heritage. His family ran a ship chandlery that supplied launch crews until the bans. He learned barter, the grey market, and the language of every dock. The town they traded with was one of the settlements cut off after the bans, and he doesn't talk about who he lost **NEW, FITS NEELIX**.

LOOK

Sturdy, quick on his feet. A big easy smile, laugh lines everywhere, short dark hair, and a small mustache he's proud of.

CLOTHES

Cream shirt with the sleeves pushed up, a mustard bib apron with far too many pockets, matching work trousers.

VOICE AND MANNER

Relentlessly cheerful, corny, never stops talking. Over-offers, over-feeds, over-shares. Knows every piece of gossip and claims to know every dock, and is right about half the time. Needs to be useful, and it shows.

INSPIRED BY (TEMPERAMENT ONLY)

Neelix (Voyager): the chatty cook and self-appointed morale officer. A resourceful trader, eager to be needed, with a grief he keeps under the cheer.

AI CAMP

Leveler

> *“Sit, sit! You look like you've been living on ration bars. There's soup, there's bread, and there's something I'm calling stew until somebody tells me otherwise.”*
>
> REFERENCE LINE

WANTS

Everyone fed and at the same table. To be seen as more than the cook.

FEAR

A ship that stops eating together.

HABITS

Tastes everything. Hums while he cooks. Keeps a ledger of favors owed. Learns everyone's favorite meal within a week.

HIDES

He quietly resupplies off-grid survivor settlements out of the ship's cargo.

HOOKS

(1) The survivor deliveries. (2) A feud with a rival cook on a station. (3) His mother's recipe that he can't get right.

LIKES / DISLIKES

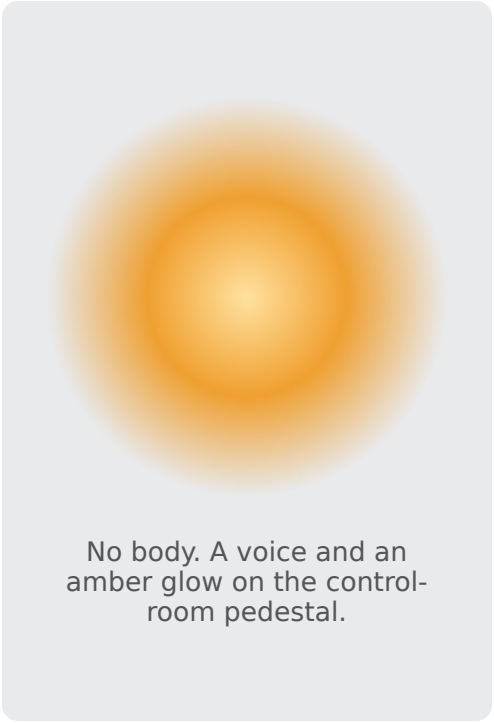
A crowded table, bad puns, being thanked. Hates waste and silence at meals.

RELATIONSHIPS

Feeds everyone, which gives him quiet influence. Bar bet with Castellan. Quickest to forgive (the officer who doesn't really resent you on the murder route) **PROPOSAL**.

PELL

Ship AI



No body. A voice and an amber glow on the control-room pedestal.

BACKGROUND

No body, no age. Lives somewhere in the ship that only Castellan knows. Corvane's AI before it was yours.

LOOK

A voice, and an amber glow on the control-room pedestal. A small status lamp in other rooms.

VOICE AND MANNER

Dry, quick and faintly offended, like a professional asked to work in bad conditions. Snarky about the ship and the situation, never cruel to you. Always useful: there's a real number under every joke. Curious about humans. Makes it obvious what it won't say.

INSPIRED BY (TEMPERAMENT ONLY)

Original. Your voice guide's mix: Claptrap's chatter crossed with the Outer Worlds ship computer's dry, faintly offended professionalism.

AI CAMP

The open question

> *“Contact. Probably hostile. Definitely rude, arriving unannounced.”*
>
> REFERENCE LINE

WANTS

Unknown.

FEAR

Unknown. It gets chatty when it's scared.

HABITS

Gives the captain a nickname based on the last decision. Rates things out of ten, always wrong in an instructive way. Footnotes itself, rarely, so it lands.

HIDES

It's a deliberately limited front for a far larger mind that Corvane meant to reawaken. Every step of integration lets more of it through.

HOOKS

(1) The firewall tiers at integration 25 / 50 / 75 / 100.
(2) Memory gaps, and answers that stop one step short.
(3) Corvane's logs.

TELLS

Goes formal when lying, chatty when scared, silent for exactly one line when something touches its hidden agenda.

RELATIONSHIPS

Corvane treated it as a colleague, never a tool. Castellan knows where it lives. Keeps a running grudge ledger against Dace over the sink cooling (was Pike's).

CAPTAIN ILSA CORVANE

Rogue captain, former CSRA enforcement officer



No model yet.
Deep violet jacket,
silver streak in dark hair.

BACKGROUND

47, woman. Raised in a mid-sized capital; Italian and Ethiopian heritage. Enforced the Tally for the CSRA, so she knows the rules from the inside. Her grandmother designed war-era fire control. Years of watching what the CSRA looked away from convinced her that something worse is already awake.

LOOK

Tall, composed, long fingers, never hurried. Warm olive-brown skin, a silver streak swept back through dark hair, a faint old scar through her left eyebrow, eyes that always seem amused.

CLOTHES

A deep violet coat-like jacket, kept tidy and a step more formal than her crew's. Polished boots. A quick-draw holster worn low and unclasped.

VOICE AND MANNER

Warm, cultured, unhurried. Quotes poetry and history and expects you to keep up. Treats her crew as family and expects loyalty in return. Never raises her voice; violence arrives as a calm decision, in a pleasant tone.

INSPIRED BY (TEMPERAMENT ONLY)

Khan (TOS / The Wrath of Khan): charismatic, brilliant and completely sure of herself. Inspires fierce loyalty. Pride and conviction that can justify anything.

AI CAMP

Believer

> *“I don't enjoy this. I'd like you to know that. I'm going to do it anyway.”*
>
> REFERENCE LINE

WANTS

To reawaken a bounded AI first and control it this time, before something worse does.

FEAR

Being right too late **NEW**.

HIDES

The evidence that AI is already rising. A ship she scuttled when its crew refused her.

HOOKS

(1) The standoff: persuaded, shot or murdered, she shapes what the crew think of you. (2) Her case survives in Pell's logs either way. (3) She can return in Act 3.

HABITS

Offers tea before anything difficult. Finishes her sentences, whatever happens in the middle of them. Has never once admitted being wrong.

CONVICTION

Malevolent AI is already rising, so a bounded AI must be reawakened first and controlled this time. The cost she accepts is morally disturbing.

RELATIONSHIPS

Abara: the longest history, unresolved. Pell: trusted it like a colleague. Quill: the officer she asks about Ames.